

Making flowers

It may take three to four years for the plant to flower. The flowers grow on a long stem high above the traps. This keeps pollinating insects attracted by the flowers' scent from accidentally getting caught.



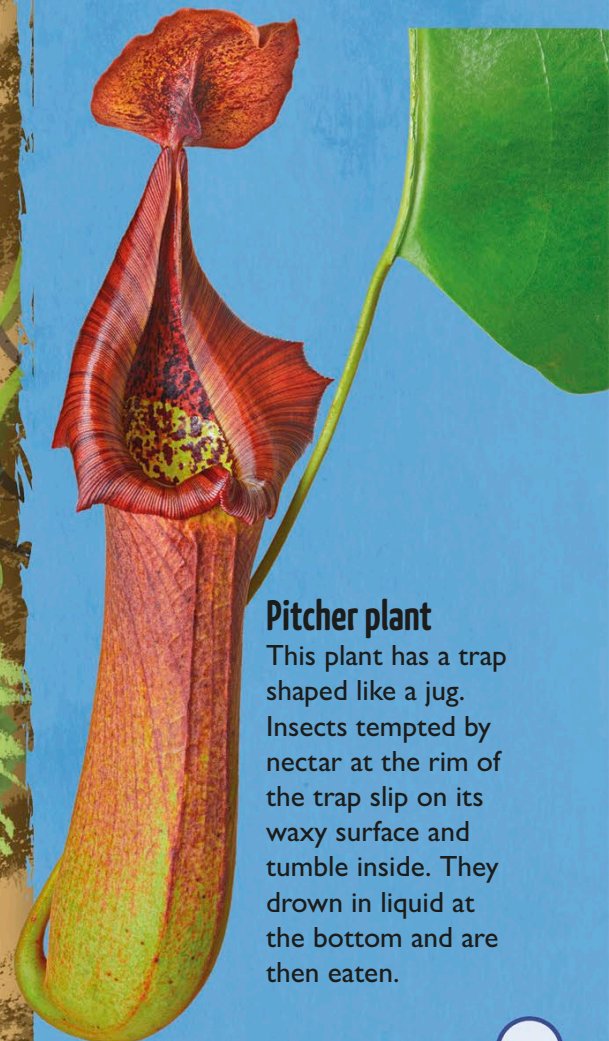
The flowers are pollinated mainly by sweat bees, checkered beetles, and long-horned beetles.

Sensitive plant The mimosa, also known as “the sensitive plant,” is another type of plant with quick reactions. Its leaves soon droop if it is touched. This makes the plant look sickly and persuades browsing animals to look elsewhere for a meal.



Venus flytrap

The extraordinary Venus flytrap is a carnivorous plant, which means it catches and “eats” unsuspecting insects and spiders that make the mistake of landing on its snapping traps. By devouring its prey in this way, it gets most of the nutrients it needs, since the poor, boggy soil that it grows in provides little nourishment.



Pitcher plant

This plant has a trap shaped like a jug. Insects tempted by nectar at the rim of the trap slip on its waxy surface and tumble inside. They drown in liquid at the bottom and are then eaten.